



Rent an Apartment

How to Find an Apartment in China Using Major Rental Platforms (Step-by-Step)

CDISCOVERY

<https://cdiscovery-community.netlify.app/>

How to Find an Apartment in China Using Major Rental Platforms (Step-by-Step)

If you're a foreigner moving to China, the smartest approach is to use established rental platforms rather than dealing with individual landlords directly. Major platforms offer verified listings, standardized contracts, English support, and dispute resolution -- things you won't get from a random landlord on WeChat. Here's a detailed walkthrough of how to find your apartment using China's biggest rental platforms.

Why Use Big Platforms Instead of Individual Landlords?

- * Verified listings

- * -- Platforms like

- * Zillow

- * and



* Lianjia

* send agents to photograph and verify every apartment. What you see online is what you get.

* Standardized contracts

* -- No surprise clauses. Platform contracts are reviewed by legal teams and follow local regulations.

* Maintenance support

* -- Something breaks? Submit a repair ticket in the app. With an individual landlord, you're calling someone who may not answer.

* Dispute resolution

* -- If there's a problem with your deposit or lease, the platform mediates. With a private landlord, you're on your own.

* English support

* -- Some platforms (especially

* Ziroom

*) have English interfaces. Others have English-speaking agents in expat areas.

Platform 1: Ziroom (自如) -- Best for Furnished Apartments

Ziroom

is China's largest managed apartment platform. Think of it as the "WeWork of apartments" -- everything is standardized, furnished, and move-in ready.

* Website:

* ziroom.com

* (app available on iOS/Android)

* What you get:

* Fully furnished apartment with Wi-Fi, washing machine, refrigerator, air conditioning, and basic kitchen. Bi-weekly cleaning service included.

* Price range:

* ¥3,000-15,000/month depending on city and room type

* Lease terms:

* 1 year minimum. "Ziroom Free" option allows shorter stays at higher rates.

* How to use:

* Download the app → select your city → browse listings → schedule viewing → sign

contract online → move in

* Payment:

* Monthly via app (WeChat Pay/Alipay/bank card). No cash.

* Pros:

* No agent fees, everything is standardized, 24/7 maintenance hotline

* Cons:

* Slightly more expensive than raw market rate, less personal touch

Platform 2: Lianjia (链家) -- Best for Long-Term Rentals

Lianjia

is China's most trusted real estate platform with 200,000+ agents nationwide.

* Website:

* lianjia.com

* Price range:

* ¥2,500-20,000/month -- wider range than Zillow

* Agent fee:

* Typically one month's rent

* Pros:

* Huge inventory, professional agents, verified ownership certificates (房产证)

* Cons:

* Agent fee, app is Chinese-only

Platform 3: Beike (贝壳找房) -- Best for Comparing Options

Beike

is the parent company of Lianjia and acts as a housing aggregator. It pulls listings from Lianjia and dozens of other agencies.

- * Website:

- * ke.com

- * Key feature:

- * "VR看房" (VR house viewing) -- tour apartments in 3D from your phone

- * Pros:

- * Largest database, VR tours, transparent pricing history

Red Flags -- Avoid These:

- * Landlord asks for deposit before viewing -- SCAM

* Price is 30%+ below market rate -- bait-and-switch

* No written contract -- always insist on one

* Landlord refuses to show 房产证 -- may not be the real owner

Sources: Sources: [Ziroom](https://www.ziroom.com) • [Lianjia](https://www.lianjia.com)

• [Beike](https://www.ke.com)

The background of the cover is a photograph of a modern, bright interior space, likely a living or dining area, with large windows on the left showing a view of a city and water. The room features light-colored walls, a beige sofa, and a dining table with chairs. Overlaid on this background are several graphic elements: a large purple circle in the center, a smaller dark grey circle in the top left, a purple rectangle in the top right, a purple rectangle in the bottom left, and a dark grey circle in the bottom right.

CDISCOVERY

Community Topics Guide

<https://cdiscovery-community.netlify.app/>

Generated on June 8, 2026

Thank you for being part of the CDISCOVERY community.